# Hein Zarni Aung

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## Cover Letter

Dear Hiring Team,

Looking through the list of projects past Dev Technology interns have built, a mentorship web application stood out to me. I spent last year mentoring international students adjusting to life in the States, one-on-one, biweekly, and it's some of the most fulfilling work I've done outside of an IDE. Seeing that kind of project as something your interns actually get to build, not just study, told me this internship treats "meaningful project" as a literal description rather than a recruiting phrase.

Most of my time these days has gone into two internships that couldn't be more different from each other. At Clustr, I've spent months building out the backend for a React Native social app (Firebase Cloud Functions, permissions logic, auth flows). The unglamorous stuff that holds an app together and has disastrous consequences for every mistake. At Prenora Dynamics, I've been given full rein over a video chat feature I had to design from scratch, reading SDK documentation and making judgment calls with no one telling me the right answer. Between the two, I've gotten comfortable moving across a React frontend and a Node-adjacent backend stack, picking up whatever the problem actually needs instead of sticking to one layer.

However, when somebody asks me about an interesting project I've done, my go-to is still the research I did with Ethos Lab. I designed a system that watches for newly issued SSL certificates and flags sites impersonating toll-payment services like EZ-Pass before they can scam anyone. It was a small two-person team and a lot of the work was tedious. We were writing Selenium scripts to scrape sites, building out heuristics, and staring at hundreds of flagged domains trying to tell real fraud from noise. It's the kind of project that taught me how to actually root-cause a problem instead of guessing at a fix and hoping it holds.

Something that's mattered to me throughout college is the role I play in my own community. I spent a year mentoring international students, and I volunteered as a TA for Data Structures & Algorithms for similar reasons, hosting weekly recitations for students who wanted a closer, less intimidating environment to ask questions in. Explaining a concept clearly to someone who's stuck on it turned out to be its own kind of engineering problem, and it's the same instinct I bring to the code I write.

Thank you for the opportunity, and I'll be looking forward to hearing back from you.

Sincerely,
Hein Zarni Aung